

- for every 30 min of theory, do 90 min of building. Always.
- ML engineer spends weeks on linear algebra, transformers from scratch, backprop. As an AI Engineer you CALL the AI model, you don't build it. That's ML Research, not AI Engineering.
- LangChain is outdated use LangGraph
- deployed project > 5 certificates. Always.
- Building RAG without measuring faithfulness/relevance is like writing Java without tests. You don't know when it breaks or why it's bad. Add RAGAS or LangSmith evals from Day 1. Make it a habit.
- You're a Java dev. Python syntax takes 2 days to get comfortable with. Stop treating it like a blocker. Just start and google what you don't know. Learn Python by building AI projects, not by taking Python courses.

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